



What You Can Do to Reduce Carbon Pollution

Climate change is a serious threat to the health and welfare of our families and our future. Many of your friends and neighbors are already taking actions to reduce the carbon pollution that contributes to climate change. The time to act is now. Here is what you can do:

Buy right.

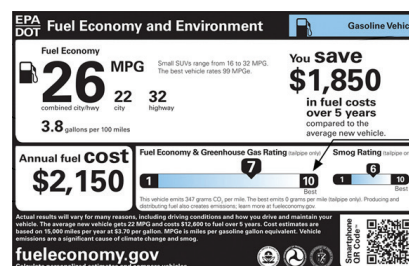
When making purchases, big or small, make efficiency a priority. You'll be saving money every day over the life of the product and reducing carbon pollution.

- **Look for the labels!** Purchase products that are energy efficient enough to have earned the **ENERGY STAR** label. Similarly, purchase products such as toilets, faucets, and showerheads that are water-efficient, and have earned the **WaterSense** label.



A household equipped with ENERGY STAR certified products can reduce greenhouse gas emissions by 107,000 pounds and save \$9,300 on utility bills over the life of these products.

- **Purchase a fuel-efficient car.** Check out www.fueleconomy.gov to find the best, most comprehensive information on vehicle emissions and fuel economy. When you're at the dealership, check out the **Gasoline Vehicle Label** to learn more about a car's fuel economy and impact on the environment. The new **Used Vehicle Label** provides fuel economy and carbon emissions information for used cars too.



Green your home.

These easy home management habits can rack up your savings and reduce your household carbon footprint.

- **Heat and cool smartly.** Use a programmable thermostat, and reduce air conditioning and heating when possible—for example when your family is at work and school, or on vacation. Use a licensed contractor to perform annual maintenance of your heating and cooling equipment. Seal and insulate your home—use caulk and weather stripping, and add insulation to your attic or seal your home's envelope to help block out heat and cold.
- **Use water efficiently.** Turn off the water while brushing your teeth. Run your dishwasher only when you have a full load of dishes. Only water the lawn when needed, and do it during the early morning.
- **Reduce, reuse, recycle.** Reduce the amount of waste you generate. Recycle your newspapers, beverage containers, paper, and other goods. Compost your food and yard waste.

It takes lots of energy to pump, treat, and heat water, so saving water reduces carbon pollution.

What You Can Do to Reduce Carbon Pollution (Cont.)

Green your ride.

A little transportation savvy will take you far in reducing carbon pollution.

- **Drive smart.** Go easy on the brakes and gas pedal—avoid hard accelerations. Reduce the time spent idling (no more than 30 seconds). Remove unnecessary items from your trunk to reduce weight. And, use cruise control if you have it.
- **Maintain your car.** Get regular tune-ups, check your tire pressure regularly, and use the recommended grade of motor oil. Also consider purchasing tires with “low rolling resistance,” an energy-saving feature.
- **Give your car a break.** Use public transportation, carpool, walk, or bike. Consider telecommuting and combining errands so you take fewer trips.

Leaving your car at home just two days a week can reduce carbon emissions by an average of two tons per year.

Personalize.

Use EPA’s Household Carbon Footprint Calculator to measure your carbon footprint and discover actions you can take to save money and reduce carbon pollution.

www.epa.gov/climatechange/ghgemissions/ind-calculator.html

Learn more at www.epa.gov/climatechange/wycd